

AI Review Report (Updated)

Manuscript: "Grading Diabetic Foot Ulcers from Colour Images: A Negative Result and its Diagnosis" (latest uploaded revision). This updates the previous AI Review Report against the changes made since then.

Recommendation

MINOR REVISION

Upgraded from the previous Major Revision. This is based on a full re-read of the manuscript against the last review pass, all 6 figures and their captions, all 6 tables, the DATASETS and REFERENCES blocks in full, and a check of every finding raised previously. Twelve of the sixteen previously-raised findings are now resolved, including the two most serious citation-accuracy problems and two small issues were introduced while fixing other things (scikit-learn lost its citation number; the DATASETS list wasn't relabeled to match its own updated in-text citations). None of these need structural rework — they're additions and corrections to existing text, which is why this now sits at Minor rather than Major Revision.

Overall Assessment

Area	Score /10	Main concern
Title	7	Unchanged — still an AI-pattern colon-list title, not addressed this round
Novelty	9	Unchanged — the validated negative result + readable gate diagnostic is genuinely novel
Methodology	10	Unchanged — formally complete and consistent
Dataset rigor	9	Kaggle link now present; all three datasets fully documented
Experimental validity	9	Unchanged — control experiment remains the paper's strongest asset
Ablation	9	Caption typo fixed; table itself was already complete
Explainability	9	Grad-CAM now correctly cited to its origin paper
Claims	10	Unchanged — claims remain appropriately hedged
References	8	36 references against a 40-60 requirement; only ~35% from 2023-2026; numbering collides with the Datasets block
Writing	8	Several fixes landed (captions, table typos, spelling); grammar in Abstract/Intro/Related Work and two wrong section refs remain
Overall	8.8	Citation-accuracy items are essentially resolved; reference count and a few leftover cross-references are what's left

Appendix — research_paper_instructions.md Submission Checklist Audit (Updated)

Requirement	Status	Where
Title	Weak	Unchanged — not addressed this round
Abstract	Present	Untraceable figure removed; now internally consistent
Introduction + bulleted contributions	Present	Section I, p. 1-2
Related Work (thematic, comparative)	Present	Section II-A to II-D, p. 2
Critical Gaps and Limitations (mandatory)	Present	Section II-E, p. 2-3
Core Contributions (bulleted)	Present	Section I, p. 1-2
Methodology deep enough to reimplement	Present	Section III, p. 3-6
Mathematical formulation of novel components	Present	Eq. 1-11, p. 3-6
Full dataset details + working links	Present	Section IV-A, p. 6 — all three datasets now linked
Code-availability statement	Present	Section IV-D, p. 7
Complete experimental setup	Present	Section IV-B, Table II
Justified evaluation metrics	Present	Section IV-C
Comparison table vs. recent literature	Present	Table VI
Ablation study (mandatory)	Present	Table V — caption typo now fixed
Explainability analysis	Present	Section V-F — Grad-CAM citation now correct
Results and discussion with interpretation	Present	Sections V-VI
Honest limitations section	Present	Section VII — a genuine strength
Concrete future work	Present	Section VIII
Conclusion	Present	Section IX
40-60 IEEE references, mostly 2023-2026	Missing	36 total, still ~third recent (Finding 2)
Accurate citations (titles, authors match sources)	Weak	Two entries fixed this round; [22] still a duplicate (Finding 1)
High-quality figures/tables, referenced in text	Weak	Two of three wrong section cross-references remain (Finding 3); Fig. 3(b) has a residual wording issue (Finding 9)
Original writing, verified and refined	Weak	Grammar issues persist in Abstract/Intro/Related Work (Finding 8)